

Public-Data Crypto Perpetual Alpha Hypotheses

Research perimeter

These are hypotheses, not validated signals. I filtered for structures that can be built from official exchange data, public issuer or protocol pages, or forward live capture. Kraken's public stack already covers historical OHLCV, time-and-sales, order book snapshots, downloadable CSVs, current futures metadata, historical funding, and a charts API with open interest, liquidation volume, CVD, orderbook, spreads, liquidity, slippage, future basis, and funding. Bybit's public stack exposes instruments metadata, funding history, open interest, index-price and premium-index klines, a public trade stream, an all-liquidation WebSocket, announcement endpoints, pre-listing flags, and downloadable historical data. That is enough to compute most of the state variables below without paying a data vendor, although a few ideas are best started as forward-capture projects for deeper book state and cleaner liquidation sequencing. ¹

The useful non-exchange layer is also public. U.S. ETF issuers publish daily holdings, U.S. listing venues publish cash-session hours, CME and CF Benchmarks publish crypto benchmark and trading-hour details, Circle and Tether publish stablecoin transparency data, Etherscan exposes token-transfer APIs, DefiLlama offers free fees and revenue APIs, Snapshot exposes governance data, GitHub exposes release timestamps, The Graph allows subgraph queries, and Google Trends data can be exported as CSV or accessed through Google's Trends API alpha. That mix is enough to test session-flow, governance, stablecoin, narrative, and event-driven ideas at a small-firm scale. ²

Liquidation and microstructure hypotheses

Mark-Lag Stop Vacuum. Mechanism: in thin perpetuals, margin calls and liquidation logic key off mark price, while many discretionary stop orders key off last price; when mark runs away from last without a broad index move, weak hands can be liquidated before the visible stop cascade appears, creating a brief forced-flow vacuum that often snaps back. This is not a generic reversal trade because the setup only exists when mark, last, and index disagree at the same time and liquidation flow confirms the distortion. Context: low-depth alts, high leverage, and sharp but non-news-driven moves. Exact trigger: mark-last divergence above the pair's rolling 95th percentile, same-direction liquidation volume above 3 standard deviations, and index return under 0.5 standard deviations over one minute. Entry/exit/stop sketch: fade the liquidation direction after one minute if CVD stops extending; exit when mark-last divergence falls below median or after ten minutes; stop on a fresh index break of 0.75 standard deviations. Required data: Kraken mark/ analytics stack or Bybit premium-index, index, trade, and liquidation streams. No-vendor feasibility: high. First test design: event study of extreme mark-last gaps conditioned on liquidation intensity. Strongest reason it might fail: real information shocks can look identical to structural dislocations. Source/evidence basis: Kraken explicitly explains that liquidation is mark-driven rather than last-price-driven, and Bybit publishes the index, premium, funding, trade, and liquidation state needed to measure the mismatch. Priority: **High.** ³

Liquidation Shadow Without Print. Mechanism: a liquidation burst can be larger than what is obvious from visible trade prints if the liquidation engine is walking thin or partially hidden liquidity; the useful

signal is not the liquidation itself, but the gap between forced-flow intensity and the small initial spot or index move. This is not standard momentum because the edge comes from forced-order imbalance relative to observed price discovery, not from past returns. Context: fast tapes in low-cap contracts where liquidations hit more quickly than broader spot arbitrage. Exact trigger: liquidation volume above the 99th percentile in a 1–5 minute bucket, trade-volume-to-liquidation-volume ratio below its 10th percentile, and the corresponding spot basket moving less than 0.4 standard deviations. Entry/exit/stop sketch: trade in the liquidation direction if post-burst CVD remains aligned for the next 30–60 seconds; exit on the first opposite-sign liquidation burst or 1 ATR on a 5-minute horizon; stop if the index does not confirm within two minutes. Required data: Kraken liquidation-volume plus trade-volume analytics, or Bybit all-liquidation and trade streams. No-vendor feasibility: medium to high; better with forward capture. First test design: compare next-5-minute drift after liquidation bursts with and without spot confirmation. Strongest reason it might fail: some venues compress or filter liquidation reporting, so the “shadow” could be partly a reporting artifact. Source/evidence basis: Kraken exposes liquidation-volume analytics, Bybit publishes all-liquidation and trade streams, and recent microstructure research shows hidden liquidity matters during liquidation cascades. Priority: **High**. 4

Cross-Venue Liquidation Translation. Mechanism: when a large venue forces liquidation in a major asset or sector leader, smaller venues or thinner correlated perps sometimes move with a short lag because their books are not the first place the liquidation happened, but they are still downstream of the same hedge and de-risking flow. This is not ordinary lead-lag momentum; it is a conditional translation trade that only matters when the leader move is clearly forced, not informational. Context: correlated alt-perp complexes, especially when the follower venue is shallower than the leader venue. Exact trigger: a Bybit liquidation burst in the leader asset above 3 standard deviations, follower-venue orderbook depth in the bottom quartile, and follower CVD still flat after 10–30 seconds. Entry/exit/stop sketch: enter with the leader’s direction on the follower venue; exit when follower aggressor differential catches up, or after five minutes; stop if the leader’s liquidation stream stops and the follower still does not move. Required data: Bybit liquidation stream, Kraken orderbook/liquidity/CVD analytics, and spot beta mapping. No-vendor feasibility: high. First test design: timestamp-align leader liquidation bursts to follower returns and compare low-depth versus high-depth follower books. Strongest reason it might fail: exchange segmentation can break the translation path in quieter regimes. Source/evidence basis: Bybit’s public liquidation stream and Kraken’s public analytics stack make the lag measurement directly testable. Priority: **High**. 5

Open-Interest Vacuum Continuation. Mechanism: a sharp drop in open interest with only a modest price move can mean that weak positions were flushed, but price discovery is incomplete because the surviving side still has room to press. The signal is the disconnect between position destruction and limited price travel. This is not a standard breakout setup because it only activates when OI collapses faster than price. Context: post-squeeze cleanouts and post-liquidation stabilization windows. Exact trigger: 5-minute OI down more than 2 standard deviations, liquidation volume above 2 standard deviations, price change below 1 standard deviation, and CVD still aligned with the pre-flush trend. Entry/exit/stop sketch: join the still-aligned CVD direction on the first pullback; exit when OI stabilizes or after 1.5 ATR; stop if OI rebuilds against the position. Required data: Kraken analytics or Bybit open-interest plus liquidation/trade data. No-vendor feasibility: high. First test design: conditional event study on OI collapses split by subsequent CVD sign. Strongest reason it might fail: some OI drops are benign position reductions rather than forced flushing. Source/evidence basis: Kraken and Bybit both expose the needed OI state, and recent work on stress in perpetual markets finds that OI collapses coincide with weaker arbitrage pass-through and structural dislocation. Priority: **High**. 6

Dual-Reference Wick Trap. Mechanism: if a breakout happens in last price but mark remains inside the prior range, breakout chasers can get trapped because the only thing that moved was the local print, not the liquidation or fair-value reference. This is not a plain mean-reversion trade because the edge is in the disagreement between trigger domains, not in the size of the wick alone. Context: thin books, slower spot constituents, and clustered stop orders just outside visible intraday highs or lows. Exact trigger: last price breaks a prior range by more than 0.3 ATR, while mark stays inside the range and index stays within 0.2 ATR. Entry/exit/stop sketch: fade the breakout back toward the range midpoint; exit at the opposite edge of the inside-mark range; stop if mark confirms the break. Required data: last, mark, and index histories from Kraken or Bybit. No-vendor feasibility: high. First test design: compare false-break frequency when mark confirms versus does not confirm. Strongest reason it might fail: in the fastest names, mark catches up almost immediately and the window disappears. Source/evidence basis: Kraken's mark-versus-last framework and Bybit's separate index and premium histories make this distinction observable. Priority: **Medium-High.** ⁷

Basis-Slippage Combo Fade. Mechanism: when future basis widens together with slippage deterioration and poor displayed liquidity, but the spot basket has not moved much, the move is often a perp-only dislocation rather than a clean directional repricing. This is not generic basis mean reversion because it needs three structural variables to line up at once: basis, slippage, and orderbook weakness. Context: low-cap or newly listed perps where displayed depth is fragile. Exact trigger: future basis widens above a rolling 90th percentile, Kraken slippage and liquidity metrics worsen above 2 standard deviations, and spot basket return remains below 0.5 standard deviations. Entry/exit/stop sketch: short the perp against spot or against a beta hedge; exit when slippage normalizes or basis mean reverts halfway; stop if spot begins to move in the same direction. Required data: Kraken future-basis, slippage, liquidity, and spot basket prices. No-vendor feasibility: high on Kraken. First test design: classify wide-basis events by slippage regime and compare reversion speeds. Strongest reason it might fail: delayed spot repricing can turn an apparent dislocation into a real trend. Source/evidence basis: Kraken's analytics API explicitly publishes future basis, liquidity, and slippage measures; academic work also finds liquidity-provision returns are stronger in smaller and less liquid crypto markets. Priority: **High.** ⁸

Funding, collateral, and index hypotheses

Funding TWAP Pin. Mechanism: on Bybit, funding is updated every minute and calculated as a time-weighted average of minute-level premium and interest components over the funding interval, so late-window attempts to push premium can distort perp pricing into the print and then unwind once the funding transfer is locked. This is not a standard funding fade because the edge is in the end-of-window premium distortion, not in the level of funding by itself. Context: heavily crowded contracts in the final 20–30 minutes before funding. Exact trigger: final-interval premium-index z-score above 2, estimated funding shift above the pair's 90th percentile, and spot/index still quiet. Entry/exit/stop sketch: fade the premium distortion just after the funding timestamp if OI starts falling; exit when premium mean-reverts halfway; stop if CVD keeps extending in the pre-funding direction. Required data: Bybit funding history, instruments metadata, premium-index klines, index-price klines, and trade flow. No-vendor feasibility: high. First test design: compare 5–30 minute post-funding returns after large late-window premium moves versus ordinary funding prints. Strongest reason it might fail: a real trend can continue straight through funding and make the distortion look justified. Source/evidence basis: Bybit documents minute-updated funding, interval metadata, and historical premium/index data. Priority: **High.** ⁹

Funding Freeze Into Negative Basis. Mechanism: if funding stays rich but futures basis compresses or rolls over, the carry regime is deteriorating under the surface; the long crowd is still paying, but curve support is no longer expanding. This is not a simple “short high funding” rule because it needs a contradiction between two carry measures. Context: crowded long regimes after several positive funding windows. Exact trigger: three consecutive positive funding prints, current funding still above the 75th percentile, 30-minute future basis z-score below zero, and OI no longer rising. Entry/exit/stop sketch: short perp versus spot or trade outright short; exit on basis normalization or after the next funding print; stop if basis re-expands with rising OI. Required data: Kraken funding and future-basis analytics, or Bybit funding plus an exchange-traded futures proxy if using another venue. No-vendor feasibility: high on Kraken, medium elsewhere. First test design: cross-tab future returns by funding regime and basis regime separately. Strongest reason it might fail: venue-specific collateral demand can compress basis temporarily without implying crowd unwind. Source/evidence basis: Kraken publishes both funding and future-basis analytics, and recent research on perpetual stress links OI dislocation to weaker basis-to-funding pass-through. Priority: **High.** 10

Collateral Haircut Reflex. Mechanism: in unified or multi-collateral systems, non-USD collateral is recognized at a discounted collateral-value ratio or haircut. When the collateral asset itself drops, traders lose usable equity faster than simple position PnL suggests, which can force reductions in other positions they are holding. The trade target is often not the collateral asset itself, but correlated perps elsewhere in the same account. This is not standard cross-asset contagion because the transmission channel is margin accounting, not discretionary de-risking alone. Context: high leverage in accounts using BTC, ETH, or volatile collateral rather than stables. Exact trigger: large collateral-asset move down, open interest in correlated alt perps starting to fall, and funding still not yet reset. Entry/exit/stop sketch: short the correlated alt basket once OI begins to roll over; exit when funding normalizes or OI collapse exhausts; stop if OI stabilizes despite further collateral weakness. Required data: collateral-ratio schedules, major-collateral prices, OI/funding in correlated perps. No-vendor feasibility: medium to high. First test design: event-study alt-perp returns after large moves in common collateral assets, split by funding and OI state. Strongest reason it might fail: many traders still margin mostly in stablecoins, so the mechanical link may be weaker than expected. Source/evidence basis: Bybit and Kraken both document collateral-value ratios and multi-collateral margining; Deribit’s cross-collateral framework points to the same structural channel. Priority: **Medium-High.** 11

Coin-M Convexity Scarcity. Mechanism: inverse, coin-margined contracts force the trader to post the base asset as collateral. In a sharp rally, shorts in inverse contracts lose both on price and on the collateral denomination dynamic, so buyback pressure can be more violent than in linear perps. The best version is often a relative-value trade between contract types rather than a naked directional bet. This is not a standard squeeze idea because the key state variable is contract collateral denomination. Context: sharp up-moves after a period of heavy inverse open interest. Exact trigger: base asset up more than 2 standard deviations intraday, coin-M OI elevated versus its 20-day median, and inverse basis not yet exploded relative to linear peers. Entry/exit/stop sketch: long the underlier or long linear versus short inverse spread; exit after basis/funding spike or OI collapse; stop if both contract types reprice evenly. Required data: coin-M contract metadata, OI, basis, and comparable linear perp data. No-vendor feasibility: medium; easier on Kraken and venues with clear inverse exposure. First test design: compare rally continuation and basis widening when inverse OI is high versus low. Strongest reason it might fail: inverse open interest can now be too small on some venues to matter often. Source/evidence basis: Kraken’s collateral documentation distinguishes inverse base-collateral contracts from multi-collateral linears. Priority: **Medium.** 12

Stablecoin Chain-Rotation Lead. Mechanism: stablecoin issuance and native cross-chain routing can move before a sector's CEX perps wake up. The useful setup is not "more stablecoins is bullish," but "fresh USDC or USDT supply plus chain-specific routing into an ecosystem where narrative attention and perp funding are still cool." This is not standard momentum because the catalyst is settlement infrastructure moving ahead of price. Context: ecosystem rotations into Base, Solana, Ethereum L2s, or RWA-heavy chains. Exact trigger: stablecoin mint or circulation increase, chain-transfer or CCTP flow surge into a target ecosystem, and representative ecosystem perps still near flat funding with compressed realized vol. Entry/exit/stop sketch: long the liquid ecosystem beta perp into the next active session; exit on funding spike or narrative-overheat signal; stop if stablecoin flow reverses quickly. Required data: Circle transparency and CCTP endpoints, Tether circulation data, token-transfer APIs, and ecosystem perp funding. No-vendor feasibility: medium; some wallet mapping may need a hand-built whitelist. First test design: rank ecosystem returns after large stablecoin flow shocks, conditioned on pre-shock funding. Strongest reason it might fail: stablecoin movement can reflect OTC settlement or yield rotation rather than spot buying intent. Source/evidence basis: Circle discloses weekly reserve holdings with mint/burn flows and CCTP transfers, Tether publishes circulation metrics, and Etherscan's API exposes token transfers. Priority: **Medium-High.** 13

Index-Component Glitch Filter. Mechanism: if a perp's index moves because one constituent venue leads or glitches while the median of other spot venues does not confirm, the mark can shift enough to create liquidations or breakout chasing on the perp even though broad spot consensus has not moved. This is not a vanilla mean-reversion trade because it depends on the internal construction of the index and mark process. Context: assets with fragmented spot markets and thin crypto-native perps. Exact trigger: index-price move above the asset's 90th percentile for one-minute changes, median of a broader external spot basket lagging materially, and premium/last price overshooting in the same direction. Entry/exit/stop sketch: fade the perp move if the broader basket starts to pull the index back; exit when mark-last gap closes; stop if the broader spot basket catches up instead. Required data: Bybit index-price and premium-index histories plus a hand-built external spot median. No-vendor feasibility: medium to high. First test design: rebuild alternative basket medians and test reversion after constituent-led index shocks. Strongest reason it might fail: a legitimate price discovery venue can lead the pack, making the move real rather than spurious. Source/evidence basis: Bybit documents separate index-price and premium-index histories and explains the weighted spot-basket construction behind index prices. Priority: **Medium.** 14

Session, ETF, and regulated-venue hypotheses

Cash-Window Confirmation at the U.S. Open. Mechanism: crypto trades all night, while U.S. ETF and equity access concentrates around fixed cash windows. Overnight BTC moves sometimes get either validated or faded when the 9:30 a.m. ET cash session opens and traditional desks start hedging. The point is not to predict the open mechanically; it is to trade the interaction between overnight basis and the first cash-session volatility impulse. This is not ordinary session momentum because it needs both an overnight move and a basis state. Context: large overnight moves into a U.S. weekday. Exact trigger: 8:00–9:29 a.m. ET BTC move above 1 standard deviation, perp basis widening or compressing unusually into the open, and realized volatility spiking in the first five minutes after 9:30. Entry/exit/stop sketch: if basis keeps widening in the first five minutes, trade with the overnight move; if basis compresses sharply, fade it; exit within 15–45 minutes; stop on a move back through the opening range. Required data: crypto only if you want a first-pass version; ETF prices are optional for refinement. No-vendor feasibility: high. First test design: split U.S.-open returns by overnight move sign and pre-open basis state. Strongest reason it might fail: once ETF integration becomes fully internalized, the open impulse may shrink. Source/evidence basis: U.S. equity and

ETF sessions are time-bounded, ETF issuers publish daily holdings, and recent work finds that ETF markets matter materially for Bitcoin price discovery. Priority: **High**. 15

BZX Hand-Off at 4 a.m. ET. Mechanism: Cboe BZX's early trading session starts at 4:00 a.m. ET, which creates a new hand-off point between the 24/7 crypto tape and U.S. listed crypto-linked instruments. The signal is the step change in crypto order-flow behavior right around that boundary, not the time of day by itself. This is not simple order-flow seasonality because the window matters only if liquidity, spreads, and aggressor flow shift together. Context: weekdays with overnight crypto moves but no major macro release. Exact trigger: 3:50–4:10 a.m. ET step change in BTC or ETH aggressor differential, spread compression, or basis behavior relative to the preceding hour. Entry/exit/stop sketch: trade with the new microstructure direction for 30–60 minutes; exit if the pre-4 a.m. regime reasserts; stop if spreads widen back out and CVD stalls. Required data: crypto trade and spread data only. No-vendor feasibility: high. First test design: compare returns and microstructure metrics before and after 4:00 a.m. ET across weekdays. Strongest reason it might fail: the effect may be absorbed into broader U.S. session behavior and weaken over time. Source/evidence basis: Cboe publishes its early-trading schedule, and crypto markets remain open continuously while equities do not. Priority: **Medium-High**. 16

London Fix Shadow. Mechanism: the CME CF Bitcoin Reference Rate is fixed at 4:00 p.m. London time, and benchmarked institutional activity can pull hedging and basis management into that window. The edge is not “trade the fix” in general, but “fade or follow the drift depending on whether the move is broad-spot-confirmed or just perp-local.” This is not a standard intraday reversal. Context: quiet pre-fix periods where basis has drifted away from broader spot. Exact trigger: 15:45–16:05 London, pre-fix realized vol below median, live perp versus broader spot-basket gap above the 80th percentile. Entry/exit/stop sketch: if the move is perp-local, fade it after the fix; if broader spot confirms, go with it into the next 15–30 minutes; stop if the fix window creates a new spot-led breakout. Required data: perp prices and a multi-venue spot basket. No-vendor feasibility: medium to high. First test design: compare post-fix reversal rates after quiet versus already-volatile approaches to the benchmark window. Strongest reason it might fail: macro releases or Europe-close flows can dominate the fix effect. Source/evidence basis: CME CF publishes BRR methodology and timing, and CME uses CF benchmarks as the underlying reference framework for crypto products. Priority: **Medium**. 17

Saturday Maintenance Reopen. Mechanism: CME crypto futures now trade nearly continuously, but still have a two-hour Saturday maintenance pause. That is far narrower than the old weekend gap, which means any remaining “gap” edge must come from a specific reopening inventory shock rather than from the old folklore. This is not the standard CME-gap meme; it is a much more conditional maintenance-window trade. Context: unusually large BTC or ETH move during the maintenance interval. Exact trigger: price move during the maintenance pause above 0.75 standard deviations and a related shift in perp basis or OI right after reopen. Entry/exit/stop sketch: if reopen flow confirms the move and basis is not yet stretched, trade continuation for 30–90 minutes; if basis already overshot, fade the reopen; stop if reopen volume is weak and the move stalls fast. Required data: CME trading-hours calendar plus crypto perp basis and trade flow. No-vendor feasibility: medium. First test design: event study of Saturday maintenance windows before and after CME's move to near-24/7 trading. Strongest reason it might fail: the window is now so small that the edge may be episodic rather than persistent. Source/evidence basis: CME's published crypto trading hours show 24/7 trading with a brief maintenance exception. Priority: **Medium**. 18

Friday Holdings Echo Into Monday. Mechanism: spot ETF issuers publish daily Bitcoin holdings; large Friday changes can leave some weekend inventory imbalance in the background even though the funds

themselves do not trade over the weekend. The useful expression is usually Monday crypto-session positioning rather than trying to infer every creation or redemption mechanically. This is not a generic “buy ETF inflows” rule because the signal comes from Friday holdings change interacting with weekend liquidity and Monday reopening. Context: strong Friday holdings move, quiet weekend realized vol, and stretched Sunday-night basis. Exact trigger: Friday holdings change above the 90th percentile, weekend realized vol below its 20-day median, and Sunday-night basis still elevated in the direction of the Friday change. Entry/exit/stop sketch: hold with the Friday holdings direction into Europe/U.S. Monday morning; exit by the U.S. cash open; stop if Monday Asia reverses through the weekend range. Required data: official issuer holdings pages and crypto basis. No-vendor feasibility: high at daily frequency. First test design: Monday return regressions on Friday holdings change split by weekend volatility regime. Strongest reason it might fail: holdings updates may reflect operational timing and not true incremental demand intensity. Source/evidence basis: BlackRock and Grayscale publish holdings and quantity data on official pages. Priority: **Medium-High.** ¹⁹

Regulated-Onshore Versus Offshore Basis Split. Mechanism: the arrival of CFTC-regulated perpetual futures in the United States creates a new venue class with different leverage, customer mix, and risk controls. When regulated U.S.-hour price discovery diverges from offshore basis behavior, smaller crypto-native perps can sometimes mean-revert toward whichever venue is setting the marginal hedge. This is not a basic cross-exchange arbitrage trade because the structural point is regime segmentation between venue types. Context: U.S. daytime, regulatory news, or institutional-risk-off windows. Exact trigger: Kraken U.S.-hour BTC or ETH basis diverging from an offshore venue by more than a rolling threshold while alt-sector perps remain slow to reprice. Entry/exit/stop sketch: trade the laggard venue or related alt beta in the direction of the leading basis signal; exit when basis spread normalizes; stop if both venues start moving together without convergence. Required data: public basis or mark/index series across Kraken and an offshore venue. No-vendor feasibility: medium. First test design: compare lead-lag directionality before and after regulated U.S. perps launched. Strongest reason it might fail: liquidity on the regulated venue may remain too small to lead often. Source/evidence basis: Kraken launched CFTC-regulated U.S. perpetuals in June 2026, and the CFTC’s May 2026 actions formally opened the door for crypto perpetuals to be treated as futures in the U.S. Priority: **Medium-High.** ²⁰

Listing, unlock, and narrative hypotheses

Pre-Market to Official Contract Regime Flip. Mechanism: Bybit pre-market perpetuals can trade before a token’s broad public listing, and once the asset is listed on at least three CEXs the contract transitions into standard perpetual trading with potential changes in risk parameters, fees, and index composition. Distorted pre-market price discovery can either unwind or accelerate during that regime change. This is not simple listing momentum because the key event is the contract-structure transition. Context: heavily talked-about launches with active pre-market trading. Exact trigger: `isPreListing` flips or the transition window is announced, and the contract enters the event with extreme premium, funding, or OI. Entry/exit/stop sketch: if pre-market premium and funding were overcrowded, fade the first post-transition extension; if pre-market interest was weak and the token gets broad CEX support, follow the breakout; stop if post-transition index constituents broaden and confirm the move. Required data: Bybit instruments info, announcement feed, premium/index histories, and trade flow. No-vendor feasibility: high. First test design: event-study all pre-listing-to-standard conversions and sort by pre-transition premium/OI. Strongest reason it might fail: some pre-market symbols are too idiosyncratic for robust sample size. Source/evidence basis: Bybit documents pre-listing contract flags, transition mechanics, and announcement feeds. Priority: **High.**

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Announcement API Latency Basket. Mechanism: exchange listing announcements generate spillovers into already-listed correlated names before the newly announced asset itself becomes the best instrument to trade. The better expression is often the liquid sector leader or the closest comparable perp that still has room to move. This is not a generic narrative trade because the catalyst timestamp is a concrete exchange announcement, not a social mood swing. Context: listings in AI, RWA, DeFi, restaking, or meme clusters. Exact trigger: new-listing announcement from Bybit or an asset appearing on Kraken's listings roadmap while the liquid category leader has not yet moved more than 0.5 standard deviations. Entry/exit/stop sketch: long the liquid category leader or long laggards in the same cluster; exit by the announced listing time or end of day; stop if the category leader immediately fails on volume. Required data: Bybit announcement endpoint, Kraken listings page, and category mapping from CoinGecko. No-vendor feasibility: high. First test design: timestamp announcement events and measure 1–24 hour sector spillovers. Strongest reason it might fail: in some themes, the listed coin absorbs nearly all attention and comparable names no longer react. Source/evidence basis: Bybit exposes announcements via API, Kraken maintains a public listings page, and CoinGecko provides category data. Priority: **High.** 22

Launchpool Distribution Overhang. Mechanism: Launchpool and similar reward programs create a mechanically similar seller cohort: users who farm rewards and then de-risk once deposits, transfers, or spot trading open. The useful conditional version is to trade the mismatch between expected farmer selling and actual perp crowding. This is not routine listing fade, because if perp funding stays muted and the reward float is mostly absorbed, the second leg can be up, not down. Context: reward distributions near token listing. Exact trigger: documented distribution/listing timeline, funding still flat to mildly positive, and the initial listing pop failing to produce a funding blowout. Entry/exit/stop sketch: short the first exaggerated pop if funding spikes fast; otherwise wait for absorption and go long if the first dip holds with stable funding; stop if the token never trades heavy enough to confirm the farmer-overhang thesis. Required data: exchange announcement timelines, perp funding, and first-day volume. No-vendor feasibility: high. First test design: compare first-24-hour and second-day returns for launchpool-linked versus ordinary listings. Strongest reason it might fail: tiny floats can overpower farmer selling and keep squeezing higher. Source/evidence basis: Bybit publishes launchpool timelines and eligibility mechanics in official announcements and product pages. Priority: **Medium-High.** 23

Cliff Unlock Absorption Trade. Mechanism: scheduled token unlocks are often front-run mechanically, so the interesting state is when OI rises into the unlock but funding stays flat or even negative. That pattern can indicate hedged anticipation rather than euphoric long crowding, and if price survives the event the pressure was already warehoused. This is not the basic “short unlocks” play. Context: large cliff unlocks in tokens with liquid perps. Exact trigger: unlock above 3% of circulating supply or large relative to 20-day spot volume, OI up above 2 standard deviations in the three days before the event, and funding near zero or negative into the unlock. Entry/exit/stop sketch: if the event day closes green and OI falls, go long for the next three to seven days; if the event day closes red and OI rises, stay short; stop on a break through the event-day range. Required data: public unlock calendar plus exchange OI/funding. No-vendor feasibility: medium to high; always verify the schedule because unlocks change. First test design: panel study of unlock events split by pre-event OI/funding state. Strongest reason it might fail: the public unlock schedule can be wrong or recipient behavior can differ from assumptions. Source/evidence basis: public unlock calendars are available from Tokenomist and CoinGecko, and Tokenomist explicitly notes that unlock schedules must be validated across sources because vesting conditions change. Priority: **High.** 24

Sector Leader Exhaustion Rotation. Mechanism: when a whole narrative is working, the first trade is usually the leader; the second trade is often the laggard that has not yet been crowded by funding and OI.

The edge appears when the leader's perp crowding is exhausted but category-level demand persists. This is not classic cross-sectional momentum because the setup requires category persistence with leader over-ownership. Context: hot themes such as RWA, restaking, AI, or Layer-2 infrastructure. Exact trigger: category return top decile over 14 days, leader funding above its 90th percentile with flat or falling OI, while a second-tier token in the same category has flat funding and rising spot volume. Entry/exit/stop sketch: long the laggard, optionally short the leader; exit on funding normalization or when the laggard itself becomes crowded; stop if category breadth collapses. Required data: CoinGecko category definitions and exchange funding/OI. No-vendor feasibility: high. First test design: rank within-category tokens by funding and OI crowding and test forward relative returns. Strongest reason it might fail: not every theme has enough listed perps for clean rotation baskets. Source/evidence basis: CoinGecko exposes category data and recent narrative research shows that capital rotates sharply across themes, including strong RWA and meme-driven narrative cycles in 2025. Priority: **High**. ²⁵

Search-Interest Compression Breakout. Mechanism: narrative attention usually explodes after price, but one underused state is when search interest stops decaying before price has broken out again. If funding has reset and realized volatility is compressed, narrative demand can restart from a cleaner positioning base. This is not just "trade social buzz," because the trade is specifically the re-acceleration after a lull. Context: themes with recurring public discussion cycles, especially AI, RWA, and restaking. Exact trigger: Google Trends downtrend flattening for 5–7 days, representative perp realized volatility in the bottom quartile, funding near zero, and a technical break above a 20-day range. Entry/exit/stop sketch: enter on the breakout close; exit when funding exceeds a crowding threshold or search interest spikes vertically; stop back inside the compressed range. Required data: Google Trends export or API, CoinGecko category mapping, and exchange funding/price histories. No-vendor feasibility: high. First test design: backtest breakouts conditioned on Trends slope regimes versus unconditioned breakouts. Strongest reason it might fail: search interest may remain coincident rather than leading for some narratives. Source/evidence basis: Google supports CSV export and now offers a Trends API alpha, while CoinGecko tracks category and narrative performance. Priority: **Medium-High**. ²⁶

DeFi, governance, and onchain-flow hypotheses

Fee Accrual Surprise Relay. Mechanism: protocol fees and revenue often move before derivatives traders update their mental model of token value. The edge is not in buying every positive revenue print, but in finding large fee inflections where perp funding is still quiet and the market has not repriced the cash-flow implication. This is not standard momentum because the state variable is business performance, not past returns. Context: DeFi exchange, lending, staking, and fee-sharing protocols with listed perps. Exact trigger: 7-day protocol fees or revenue up more than 50% versus the prior 7 days and above a 90-day z-score threshold, with perp funding still below its 60th percentile. Entry/exit/stop sketch: go long after the fee surprise is visible; exit on funding-overheat or after the next weekly data roll; stop if fees mean-revert immediately. Required data: DefiLlama fees/revenue plus exchange funding and OI. No-vendor feasibility: high. First test design: cross-sectional long-short on big positive fee surprises, neutralized by broad market beta. Strongest reason it might fail: fee spikes can come from mercenary incentives or one-off events with no durable value. Source/evidence basis: DefiLlama's free API explicitly covers fees and revenue. Priority: **High**. ²⁷

Governance Value-Accrual Drift. Mechanism: many traders still dismiss governance as noise, but proposals tied to buybacks, fee redirects, treasury deployment, staking caps, or emissions changes can create a slow repricing path before the wider market reacts. The point is to target proposals with direct

value-accrual consequences, not generic forum chatter. This is not a narrative trade because the catalyst is a proposal document and vote path. Context: mature DAO tokens with real-fee businesses and liquid perps. Exact trigger: proposal or forum thread explicitly tied to value accrual, vote participation or forum engagement rising quickly, and perp funding still neutral. Entry/exit/stop sketch: enter after quorum trajectory and passage probability become visible; exit before final execution if crowding builds, or after passage if the market is still asleep; stop on governance pushback or implementation delay. Required data: Snapshot API, research forums, and exchange funding/OI. No-vendor feasibility: high. First test design: classify proposals by direct token-economics impact and measure returns from post-proposal to post-vote windows. Strongest reason it might fail: many proposals signal intent without ever reaching implementation. Source/evidence basis: Snapshot's API is public, Lido's governance process is documented publicly, and forum plus on-chain governance paths are visible. Priority: **High.** 28

Restaking Risk Shock Beta. Mechanism: restaking and liquid-restaking ecosystems can reprice sharply around slashing or reward-rule changes, but the best trade may be the lagging correlated tokens rather than the headline protocol itself. The idea is to trade sector beta when the market learns something concrete about risk rather than just hearing the word "restaking." This is not generic sector momentum because the trigger is an explicit protocol-risk milestone. Context: restaking governance, slashing rollouts, or reward-rule updates. Exact trigger: official protocol post or release announcing slashing, reward, or AVS-rule change; restaking-category attention and returns pick up; second-tier related perps still show flat funding. Entry/exit/stop sketch: long or short the lagging sector token depending on whether the change expands or tightens demand; exit when category funding catches up; stop if the category leader fails to hold its own reaction. Required data: official blog or GitHub releases, CoinGecko restaking categories, and exchange funding. No-vendor feasibility: high. First test design: event-study official restaking milestone posts and sector spillover returns. Strongest reason it might fail: the restaking theme is still young and liquidity is uneven. Source/evidence basis: EigenLayer publicly documented slashing rollout, and CoinGecko tracks restaking and liquid-restaking categories. Priority: **Medium-High.** 29

Bridge-and-Deploy Lead. Mechanism: stablecoin or bridge inflows into a chain often matter only when they are followed by actual economic activity. The edge is the sequencing: first inflow, then DEX or protocol-fee pickup, then CEX perp repricing. This is not a blanket "bridge inflows are bullish" rule. Context: emerging L2 or sector ecosystems with tradable beta tokens. Exact trigger: stablecoin inflow or chain transfer shock above 2 standard deviations, followed within 24–72 hours by rising DEX volume or protocol fees while CEX perp funding is still flat. Entry/exit/stop sketch: long the chain beta perp after the second confirmation, not after the first; exit on funding spike or category overheat; stop if fees fail to follow the bridge activity. Required data: on-chain transfer APIs or subgraphs, DefiLlama fees/volumes, and exchange funding. No-vendor feasibility: medium to high. First test design: chain-level event study from stablecoin inflow shock to token return, conditioned on later fee confirmation. Strongest reason it might fail: bridge inflows can be airdrop farming or internal treasury movement, not deployable demand. Source/evidence basis: The Graph enables subgraph queries, Etherscan exposes transfer APIs, and DefiLlama tracks volumes, fees, and revenue. Priority: **Medium-High.** 30

GitHub Release Repricing. Mechanism: for infrastructure-heavy tokens, actual release cadence and versioned milestones can matter more than vague roadmap talk. Exchange-traded perps often react slowly when the release is technical and not immediately meme-able. This is not "buy developer activity"; it is a timestamped event trade around real shipped updates or tags. Context: middleware, protocol infrastructure, L2 tooling, or staking-stack tokens. Exact trigger: official GitHub release or tag after a quiet period, especially if it lines up with a known protocol milestone; token price initially underreacts while sector

attention is stable or rising. Entry/exit/stop sketch: enter if no strong first-hour reaction appears; exit after one to three days or when broader attention catches up; stop if the release is obviously cosmetic. Required data: GitHub releases or tags, optional protocol calendars, and exchange prices. No-vendor feasibility: high. First test design: measure returns after official releases, filtering out minor patch versions. Strongest reason it might fail: many token prices are only loosely linked to the economics of the codebase shipping the release. Source/evidence basis: GitHub's release and tag APIs are public. Priority: **Medium**. ³¹

Event-Calendar Crowding Fade. Mechanism: crypto-native technical calendars are public: AllCoreDevs calls, protocol-upgrade trackers, DAO votes, and forum milestones. Traders often crowd the event headline itself, but if the actual outcome contains no new date, parameter, or monetization change, the trade is to fade the crowding. This is not event arbitrage in the usual macro sense because the edge is in the mismatch between a public calendar and the absence of incremental content. Context: hot themes rallying into scheduled calls or votes. Exact trigger: event within 24 hours, funding above its 90th percentile, social or search attention elevated, and post-event summary lacking a new activation date or economically meaningful parameter change. Entry/exit/stop sketch: fade the post-event move immediately after the summary or meeting notes are public; exit on funding mean reversion or by the next Asia session; stop if the event unexpectedly adds a concrete bullish date. Required data: public event calendars, forum summaries, funding, and search proxies. No-vendor feasibility: high. First test design: classify events by "new information" versus "no new information" and compare post-event returns. Strongest reason it might fail: content classification is messy and may require some manual tagging at first. Source/evidence basis: Ethereum development coordination and governance calendars are public, and Google Trends plus Snapshot/forum data make crowding measurable. Priority: **High**. ³²

Top 10 weird-but-testable ideas

The list below weights three things most heavily: official-data coverage, a clean event timestamp, and a plausible structural mechanism that is narrower than generic momentum or reversal. Kraken and Bybit's public APIs are good enough to start forward capture on most of them immediately, while the governance, ETF-holdings, and fee-based variants can be run off daily public sources. ³³

- **Mark-Lag Stop Vacuum.** Best mix of structural edge and clean public observability. Mark, last, index, liquidation volume, and CVD can all be measured directly. The trap is common in thin alts and should fit a small aggressive account well.
- **Pre-Market to Official Contract Regime Flip.** Very few firms still treat exchange-structure transitions as a standalone state change. Bybit's pre-listing flags and announcement API make the event timestamp explicit.
- **Funding TWAP Pin.** Simple to build, narrowly conditioned, and likely to persist because it comes from funding mechanics rather than investor belief.
- **Cross-Venue Liquidation Translation.** Attractive for small accounts because the best opportunities are often in thinner follower markets rather than in the venue where the liquidation happened.

- **Fee Accrual Surprise Relay.** Strong from a “fake alpha” perspective because it ties price to measurable economic activity instead of chatter. Good fit for liquid DeFi perps with weak research coverage.
- **Sector Leader Exhaustion Rotation.** Especially interesting in RWA, restaking, and AI clusters where one leader absorbs most crowded funding while the rest of the category stays relatively clean.
- **Cliff Unlock Absorption Trade.** Better than the usual unlock short because it explicitly conditions on OI and funding, which is where a lot of false unlock alpha dies.
- **Cash-Window Confirmation at the U.S. Open.** Likely more relevant after Bitcoin ETF integration and the growth of regulated U.S. perp venues, but still testable with crypto data alone.
- **Governance Value-Accrual Drift.** Underfollowed, timestamped, and public. Slow-moving enough that a small firm can still get filled before the broader market digests the proposal.
- **Event-Calendar Crowding Fade.** Crude versions of this already work in crypto social trading, but a cleaner version using public protocol calendars, funding, and search data should be much harder to fake.

The common thread across these ten is that they are not trying to predict the whole market. They are trying to catch very specific moments when crypto’s plumbing becomes visible: when the mark runs away from the trade tape, when a pre-market contract becomes a real one, when a fee series jumps before the perp notices, when a public governance vote matters more than the chart, or when a whole market leans into a scheduled event and discovers there was nothing there but the clock.

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